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Emilio Barkett

Education

Columbia University 2024 – 2026
M.A. in Media Studies & Sociology
Advisors: Diane Vaughan, James Chu, David M. Markowitz
Thesis: *Status Hierarchies in Language Models*

Brigham Young University–Hawaii 2022 – 2024
B.A. in Communication; Minor in Political Science
Research Advisor: Mason Allred

Areas of Interest

AI Behavior; Evaluations Frameworks; Human-AI Interaction; Organizational Risk

Work Experience

BlueDot Berkeley, CA (*Remote*)
Facilitator Oct 2026 – Present

Supervised Program for Alignment Research Berkeley, CA (*Remote*)
Research Mentor Dec 2025 – Present

Columbia AI Alignment Club New York, NY
Research Manager / Fellowship Facilitator Jan 2025 – Dec 2025

Columbia Business School New York, NY
Research Intern June 2025 – Aug 2025
Research Advisor: Alan Zhang

Columbia University New York, NY
Research Assistant Jan 2025 – July 2025
Research Advisor: James Chu

JustServe Los Angeles, CA
Chief of Staff Apr 2020 – Dec 2020

Book

[1] Outstanding Stories from Kiribati.
Emilio Barkett
Barnes and Noble Press, 2022. [*link*]

Publications

[9] Normalization of Deviance in AI Development.†
Emilio Barkett, Alexander Kimpton, Daniel Graham, Yusuf Kundgol
NeurIPS AI4Good Workshop, 2026. [*paper*].

[8] Social Pressure Induces Moral Sycophancy in Frontier LLMs.†
Roshni Lulla*, Kristin Witte*, Saloni Modi*, **Emilio Barkett***
Working Paper.

[7] Whose Alignment? Process Alignment Across Organizational Contexts.†
Niklas Weller*, **Emilio Barkett***
ICML Workshop on Pluralistic Alignment, 2026. [*paper*].

[6] Representation Without Control: Testing the Realization Effect in Language Models.†
Ciaran Walsh, **Emilio Barkett**
arXiv preprint, 2026. [*paper*].

[5] The Compulsory Imaginary: AGI and Corporate Authority.
Emilio Barkett
arXiv preprint, 2026. [*paper*]

[4] Status Hierarchies in Language Models.
Emilio Barkett
arXiv preprint, 2026. [*paper*].

[3] Getting out of the Big-Muddy: Escalation of Commitment in LLMs.
Emilio Barkett*, Olivia Long*, Paul Kröger
arXiv preprint, 2025. [*paper*].

[2] Don't Change My View: Ideological Bias Auditing in Large Language Models.
Paul Kröger, **Emilio Barkett**
arXiv preprint, 2025. [*paper*].

[1] Reasoning Isn't Enough: Examining Truth-Bias and Sycophancy in LLMs.
Emilio Barkett*, Olivia Long*, Madhavendra Thakur*
ICML Workshop on Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment, 2025. [*paper*].

** Denotes equal contribution.*
† Denotes projects mentored through SPAR.

Works in Progress

[5] Organizational Drift in Frontier AI Development: Evidence from Policy Revisions, Personnel Testimony, and National Strategies.†
Emilio Barkett, Alexander Kimpton, Daniel Graham, Yusuf Kundgol
Working Paper.

[4] Steerability of Language Model Recommendations in Simulated Military Crises.†
Maya De Ganyar, **Emilio Barkett**
Working Paper.

[3] Agent Swarm Dynamics.†
William Neild, **Emilio Barkett**
Working Paper.

[2] Public Commitment and Counterargument Framing in LLM Belief Revision.†
Hannah Sun, **Emilio Barkett**
Working Paper.

[1] Economics of Token Output.†
Peiyu Chen, **Emilio Barkett**
Working Paper.

Awards & Fellowships

BlueDot Impact Rapid Grant, $3,000.	Sept 2026
Supervised Program for Alignment Research, $5,250.	Dec 2025 – Present
Claude Campus Ambassador, Anthropic, $1,750.	Aug 2025 – Dec 2025
AI Policy Fellowship, Columbia AI Alignment Club.	Jan 2025 – June 2025
Service Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, $1,500.	2022
Dean's List Scholarship, Brigham Young University–Hawaii, $500.	2022

Mentoring

Research Mentoring

- Peiyu Chen (2026), University of Chicago Booth School of Business.
- Maya De Ganyar (2026), UC Berkeley.
- Hannah Sun (2026), University of Washington.
- William Neild (2026), Emory.
- Alexander Kimpton (2026), Dragoman. Published. [9].
- Yusuf Kundgol (2026), Oxford. Published. [9].
- Daniel Graham (2026), State Street. Published. [9].
- Shruti Das (2026), Columbia University Masters. Former Apple.
- Weian Xie (2026), MIT.
- Saloni Modi (2026), Bloomberg. Former UT Austin. Published. [8].
- Hayzie Chu (2026), Brown University Undergrad.
- Niklas Weller (2026), University of St. Gallen PhD. Published. [7].
- Raghav Pant (2026), JPMorganChase. Former Brown University.
- Dan Sachs (2026), Independent Researcher. Former Georgetown University.
- Ciáran Walsh (2026), Columbia University Undergrad. Published. [6].
- Madhavendra Thakur (2025), Independent Researcher. Published. [1]. Now at Harvard; YC Fellow.
- Olivia Long (2025), Columbia University Undergrad. Published. [1, 3]. Former XLab.

Academic Service

Program Committee Member

- Workshops: AI for Social Impact (AAAI 2026)

Reviewer

- Conferences: NeurIPS (2025, 2026), IASEAI (2026)
- Workshops: SocialAgent (NeurIPS 2026), Interpretability as a Science (NeurIPS 2026), AI4GOOD (NeurIPS 2026), Pluralistic Alignment (ICML 2026), Models of Human Feedback for AI Alignment (ICML 2025), Socially Responsible Language Modeling Research (COLM 2025)

Technical Skills

Languages & Tools:

Python, R, HTML, Git, LaTeX, Figma, Qualtrics, Amazon MTurk, Prolific Academic, OSF, arXiv

Human Languages:

English (native), Gilbertese (advanced), American Sign Language (basic)